



A Look Back at March 2026: From ICS to the Wider World and History



March 2026 brought together voices, events, and memories that connected our school community to the wider world. From international discussions on economics, climate, and equality to cultural celebrations like International Women's Day and the arrival of spring, this month reflected both change and continuity. Major sporting events captured global attention, while history reminded us of defining moments that shaped nations and identities. Closer to home, personal experiences—like a journey through Milan—highlighted the importance of culture, friendship, and perspective. We also looked back with pride and respect at the significance of March 18, a day that reflects courage, sacrifice, and national unity. In this issue, we invite you to explore these stories.

Milan Magic to Lake Como: Travel Lesson

From a birthday moment under Milan's sunset canals to a night of street music and laughter, one student's four-day escape reveals Italy's living heartbeat. Wander through Navigli's glow, gaze at Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II, and savor Margherita pizza near the city's pulse, then drift to Lake Como for quiet elegance and calm waters. Along the way, small moments—a surprise celebration, warm hospitality, and chance encounters—turn the trip into something unforgettable. In the end, the journey offers a simple lesson: travel thrives when you abandon the map and let connection guide you.

Read more on pages 3 & 4.

Çanakkale 1915: A Nation's Un- yielding Will

On March 18, 1915, the Çanakkale Victory revealed a nation's stubborn heart and unyielding will. Soldiers faced overwhelming odds, yet leadership, courage, and a shared love for their homeland carried them forward. Atatürk's steadiness inspired grit, turning sacrifice into a pivotal moment that paved the way for independence and national pride. This tribute isn't just history—it's a reminder that resolve, unity, and belief in a just cause can shape a country's future. Read how the courage of one day still echoes across generations, inspiring freedom and strength today.

Read more on pages 4 & 5.

March 2026: A Global Mo- saic of Change

March 2026 unfolded like a global mosaic: markets, climate shocks, and diplomacy testing the nerve of nations. CSW70 spotlighted women's rights on the world stage, while spring's dawn brightened cultural rites—from the Oscars to Eid al-Fitr's celebrations.

In Milan and Cortina, the Winter Paralympics lit up the mountains, and a new Formula 1 season revved up around the globe. History's March echoes—great leaders, pivotal speeches, and turning points that remind us how events shape our future.

Read more on page 2.



March 2026: Global Shifts in Politics, Culture, Sport, History

Global Developments in March 2026 were dominated by considerations of the economy, climate, and international politics.

The United Nations Commission on the Status of Women (CSW70) convened in New York from March 9 to 20, addressing women's rights and current policies on a global scale. The European Commission approved new emergency support funds for member states to compensate for damages caused by extreme climate events in the agricultural sector. The US Federal Reserve (Fed) held monetary policy meetings that directly affected global markets and inflation expectations. Security concerns persisted in and around conflict zones, with some countries, such as the US, restricting the activities of their diplomatic missions in certain regions (e.g., Adana, Turkey) due to security risks.

Cultural Developments in March 2026 included international cultural and social commemorations. Within the scope of International Women's Day on March 8, demands for equal rights and the position of

women in the workforce were discussed globally. The 98th Academy Awards (Oscars) ceremony, which sets the standards of the cinema industry, was held. With the vernal equinox on March 20, spring began in the northern hemisphere and autumn in the southern hemisphere. Traditional celebrations related to the equinox were held in many cultures. Following the completion of the lunar month of Ramadan, Eid al-Fitr was celebrated in the Islamic world.

Sporting Developments in March 2026 saw major global winter and indoor sports organizations in action. The 2026 Winter Paralympic Games were held in Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo, Italy, from March 6 to 15. In motorsports, the Formula 1 World Championship season began, with the Australian Grand Prix held March 6-8 and the Chinese Grand Prix taking place March 13-15. The World Baseball Classic tournament was hosted by Japan, Puerto Rico, and the US from March 5 to 17. The World Athletics Indoor Championships were held in Poland from March 20-22. In men's European football, the

UEFA Champions League Round of 16 second-leg matches were played, determining the teams advancing to the quarter-finals.

March in History has seen critical events affecting political borders, regimes, and social structures. On March 15, 44 BC, Julius Caesar was assassinated in the Roman Senate, an event that accelerated the end of the Roman Republic. On March 1, 1815, Napoleon Bonaparte escaped from exile on the island of Elba and returned to France, initiating the period known as the "Hundred Days." On March 4, 1933, during the Great Depression, US President Franklin D. Roosevelt delivered his inaugural address, known for the phrase "the only thing we have to fear is fear itself." On March 5, 1946, former British Prime Minister Winston Churchill delivered his "Iron Curtain" speech, defining the Soviet Union's isolation in Europe and serving as an early symbol of the Cold War. On March 16, 1968, the My Lai Massacre was committed by US soldiers during the Vietnam War, resulting in the deaths of hundreds of civilians.

İzmir Weather Forecast

for Friday, 3 April 2026

In Izmir on Friday, April 3rd, you can expect a cool and mostly cloudy spring day, with temperatures reaching around **17–18°C during the afternoon** and dropping to **about 9°C at night**.

There is a **moderate chance of light showers**, especially earlier in the day, with cloud cover gradually breaking at times later on. Winds are generally light to moderate, and overall conditions feel fresh rather than warm.

This kind of weather is typical for early April in İzmir, where mild temperatures and occasional rain are common as spring settles in.



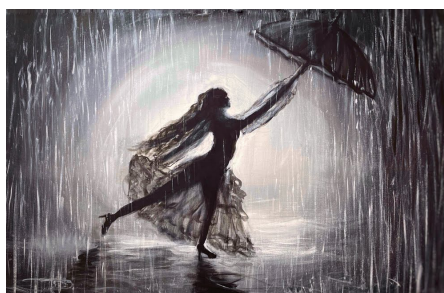
Free Yourself From Your Burdens

by *Handan Akyel*

Each of us carries burdens upon our shoulders—loads we take with us wherever we go. I suppose the time to let go of them has not only come, but is already slipping past... Time is too precious for “if onlys.” We must set regrets aside, shake ourselves awake, cast off the weight from our shoulders, and move forward—finding strength in affirmations.

Leaving the past where it belongs is perhaps the most essential step of all. As long as we dwell in yesterday, it becomes nearly impossible to take joy in today, to truly savor it. We must come to terms with the past—stop circling endlessly around old events, resentments, pains, sorrows, disappointments, and mistakes. We are human; we all have feelings, and making mistakes is part of that humanity. What truly matters is not repeating those mistakes, but learning from everything we have lived through and continuing on our path.

Just as reheating the same meal over and over dulls its taste and leaves you weary of it, constantly bringing past burdens back to the table drains the flavor from life. It breeds unease, saps our



energy, and clouds our faces, until life becomes nothing more than breathing in and out. And yet—we all deserve to close the account with the past, to open a fresh page, and to fill that page with beauty, miracles, intentions, and dreams.

Once we leave the past behind, we take a deep breath. Now is the time for purification—for a thorough cleansing. Now is the moment to rid yourself of events that weigh you down, of people who drain your energy, of objects tucked away in corners and long forgotten. Who knows—perhaps even rearranging your home could shift its energy. You might finally wear the dress you’ve been saving “for later,” or begin using the cutlery you once reserved for guests. And each time you stand before the mirror, you can remind yourself just how beautiful and valuable you truly are.

After all this, you must create

a space each day for positive thinking. When you think positively, you will notice yourself becoming happier, calmer, more creative, more energized—and even more resilient against illness. The first step toward a quality life begins with loving yourself and thinking positively. What, then, are you waiting for to do this kindness for yourself?

Think positive—let your thoughts become real. Free yourself from your burdens—let a new life find you.

With these as our guiding words, we must take hold of our strength. It is never too late to do something for yourself—because every person is special. And we women... perhaps we are a little more so. Every woman is beautiful; what matters is allowing that inner spark to shine outward. There is no room for excuses in our lives—nothing is ever truly too late.

So come—love yourself, take care of yourself, stay active, let go of whatever no longer serves you, and keep moving forward.

Let life embrace you.

A Birthday in Milan: Culture, Cuisine, and Connection

by *Gizem Eroğlu*

As the sun set over the canals of Milan and the streets filled with music, I found myself celebrating my birthday in one of the most beautiful cities in the world. I spent four days in Milan, and it became

an unforgettable experience.

In the heat of August, ending the day in the famous Navigli district with an ice-cold drink, watching the sunset, and listening to street

musicians was truly magical. Moments like these allowed me to feel the rhythm of the city—alive, vibrant, and full of character.

If you ever visit Milan, do not miss



Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II. It is not only a shopping destination but also an architectural masterpiece. Right behind the Galleria, you can visit Leonardo3, The World of Leonardo Museum, which offers a fascinating insight into creativity and innovation.

At the heart of the city, make sure to take photos in Piazza del Duomo. From there, you can easily walk to Teatro alla Scala (La Scala), one of the most prestigious opera and ballet houses in the world, reflecting Italy's deep cultural appreciation for art.



Since it is very close to Milan, I strongly recommend visiting Lake Como as well. Its natural beauty and peaceful atmosphere provide a different perspective of Italy—one that is calm, elegant, and deeply connected to nature.

One of the aspects that impressed me most about Italy was its lifestyle. Around lunchtime, life slows down, and people take time to enjoy long meals and meaningful conversations. This cultural approach, similar to a “siesta,” highlights the importance of balance, connection, and truly experiencing the present moment.



When it comes to food, Ristorante Charleston, located very close to Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II, is a great place for a delicious Margherita pizza.

I also had an unforgettable pasta experience at Ristorante Pizzeria Funicolare by Lake Como. When the owner learned that it was my birthday, he personally came to our table and offered me limoncello. This thoughtful gesture reflected

the warmth and hospitality that are deeply rooted in Italian culture, where making people feel welcome is an essential part of daily life.

What made this trip even more meaningful was a beautiful surprise. My Italian friends, whom I met while studying in Budapest, found out that I was in Milan and came to my hotel at midnight to celebrate my birthday. This moment reminded me that beyond places and experiences, it is human connection that gives meaning to travel.

No matter where you are in the world, having people who care about you makes you feel at home.

One of the most meaningful insights I gained from this experience is the value of moving beyond planned itineraries. After visiting the places you intend to see, allowing yourself to disconnect and explore without a fixed direction can lead to deeper cultural understanding. By getting a little lost, observing daily life, and engaging with the local atmosphere, you begin to truly feel a place rather than simply visit it.

This trip became even more special because of its date: 28 August 2021. It was a birthday I will never forget.

March 18: The Great Epic Written in Çanakkale

by *Yonca Turuşlar (11A)*

In our history, there are some days that show not only a victory but also the character of a nation. March 18, 1915, is one of those days. The Çanakkale Victory demonstrated to the whole world

how strong, determined, and devoted to their homeland the Turkish nation is.

Enemy states thought they could easily overcome the Ottoman

Empire. However, they faced a nation that was willing to risk everything for their homeland. In this struggle, Atatürk's leadership was of great importance.



Moreover, this victory was not only a military success. It also gave the Turkish nation great self-confidence. This confidence later laid the foundation for the War of Independence.

If we live in a free country today, we owe it to all our martyrs, especially Mustafa Kemal Atatürk. Therefore, March 18 is not only a victory but also a day of remembrance.

In conclusion, March 18 is one of the dates that best demonstrates the strength, courage, and patriotism of the Turkish nation. As a student, I think understanding how important Mustafa Kemal Atatürk's leadership was in this victory is very valuable.

Mustafa Kemal Atatürk did not only command his soldiers during the war, but he also gave them morale and courage. His words, "*I do not order you to attack; I order you to die,*" clearly show how the war was won with great sacrifice.

Even this statement proves how determined and visionary a leader Atatürk was.

Although the conditions were very difficult at that time, Atatürk and the Turkish soldiers never gave up. This shows us what can be achieved when there is strong leadership and faith.

Mobile Phones: From 1973 Invention to Everyday Learning

by Anastasia Logotheti (7A)

The mobile phone is one of the most important inventions of modern times. The first mobile phone was presented in 1973 in the United States by engineer Martin Cooper from the company Motorola. Since then, mobile phones have changed a lot and are used all over the world. Today,

people use mobile phones for schoolwork, games, and talking with friends. Research shows that an average person uses a mobile phone about 4 to 5 hours every day. Teenagers often use screens even more, about 7 hours daily. Doctors say that children should not use mobile phones for many

hours every day and they should take breaks. For example, they can play outside or they can read books. So, in my opinion, mobile phones are very useful when used correctly, as they can help us a lot with learning and communication.

March 18, 1915: The 111th Anniversary of the Gallipoli Campaign and Its Military Consequences

The battles that took place on the Gallipoli Peninsula and the Dardanelles Strait during World War I mark their 111th anniversary as of March 2026. The war was shaped around the strategic objectives of the Allied Powers and the defensive operations of the Ottoman Empire.

The Allied Powers, led by Britain and France, targeted the Dardanelles with the aim of providing military and economic supplies to their ally Russia by sea, occupying Istanbul to knock the Ottoman Empire out of the war, and drawing the Balkan states into the war on their side.

On March 18, 1915, the Allied fleet launched a comprehensive attack to force the strait using only naval power. However, the operation failed. The narrow structure of the strait and the crossfire from Ottoman artillery batteries restricted the fleet's mobility.



The mine lines previously laid in the strait caused the sinking of three Allied battleships—Bouvet, Irresistible, Ocean—and severe damage to others. The loss of heavy-tonnage ships forced the cancellation of the naval operation and a shift in strategy toward land landings.

Upon realizing the impossibility of a naval passage, land landings were initiated on the Gallipoli Peninsula on April 25, 1915. The battle quickly stalemated, turning into trench warfare in a confined area. The opposing sides were unable to capture each other's trenches for months. It was not only artillery and rifle fire; dysentery, malnutrition, thirst, extreme heat, and the freezing cold that set in during winter devastated the military personnel on both sides. Logistics

and medical supply lines proved inadequate.

After eight and a half months of land battles, the Allied Powers accepted that they could not achieve their objectives and evacuated their troops from the peninsula in December 1915 and January 1916. The Ottoman Empire protected its capital and halted the advance of the Allied Powers. The resistance on the Gallipoli front caused World War I to be prolonged by at least two more years. Russia's failure to receive the expected aid deepened the economic and political crisis in the country, accelerating the process leading to the 1917 Bolshevik Revolution.

The human cost was extremely heavy. Although exact figures vary depending on the sources,

the total number of dead, wounded, missing, and medically evacuated soldiers from both sides approaches half a million. The battles remain one of the clearest examples of military strategy errors and the devastating consequences of trench warfare. In our history, there are some days that show not only a victory but also the character of a nation. March 18, 1915, is one of those days. The Çanakkale Victory demonstrated to the whole world how strong, determined, and devoted to their homeland the Turkish nation is.

Enemy states thought they could easily overcome the Ottoman Empire. However, they faced a nation that was willing to risk everything for their homeland. In this struggle, Atatürk's leadership was of great importance.

Why Teen Creativity Matters More Than Ever

by *Yonca Turuşlar (11A)*



In today's fast-moving digital world, creativity is often seen as a luxury rather than a necessity. However, for teenagers especially, creativity is not just about art or

music—it is a powerful tool for expression, problem-solving, and personal growth.

Teenagers today face constant pressure from school, social media, and expectations about the future. Creativity offers an outlet—a way to process emotions, explore identity, and communicate ideas that might be difficult to express in words. Whether it's through drawing, writing, coding, or even creating videos, creative activities allow young people to make sense of the world around them.

Beyond emotional benefits, creativity also builds important skills. Thinking creatively

encourages flexibility, innovation, and the ability to approach problems from different perspectives. These skills are increasingly valuable in modern careers, where employers look for individuals who can adapt and think independently rather than simply follow instructions.

Interestingly, creativity does not always require special talent. It thrives on curiosity and experimentation. Trying something new, making mistakes, and learning from them are all part of the creative process. In fact, some of the most original ideas come from unexpected failures.



Despite its importance, creativity is often overlooked in education systems that focus heavily on exams and standardized results. While academic success is important, it should not come at the cost of imagination and exploration. Schools and families can support creativity by encouraging hobbies, allowing time for free thinking, and valuing originality as much as correctness.

In the end, creativity is not just about producing something impressive—it is about thinking differently and seeing possibilities where others may not. For teenagers, it can be a source of confidence, a way to stand out, and a skill that lasts a lifetime.

As the world continues to change rapidly, one thing remains clear: those who can think creatively will always have an edge.

A Memory of Atatürk

The relocation process of the mansion located at the Millet Farm in Yalova, belonging to Mustafa Kemal Atatürk, in 1930 is one of the recorded concrete events of the period. Over time, the branches of the plane tree adjacent to the two-story wooden mansion built in 1929 grew and began to rub against the roof and walls of the building. The gardeners working at the farm requested approval from Atatürk to cut the relevant branches of the tree to prevent physical damage to the building.

Instead of cutting or pruning the tree, Atatürk ordered the

building to be slid on skids away from the tree. The Roads and Bridges Branch of the Istanbul Municipality's Department of Science Affairs was assigned for the engineering aspect of the process, and a technical team led by Chief Engineer Ali Galip Alnar arrived in Yalova. The foundation of the building was excavated, and tram rails brought from Istanbul were placed underneath.

With the process starting on August 8, 1930, the structure was lifted from its foundation with jacks and placed on the rails. As a result of the operation completed

on August 11, 1930, the mansion was moved approximately 4.8 meters to the east. Following this engineering process, the roof of the building was relieved from the physical pressure of the tree, and the plane tree preserved its integrity. After this procedure, the structure unofficially took the name "The Walking Mansion".

The event is a technical and concrete example of resolving a physical conflict between landscaping and an architectural structure through the relocation of the building.

Future Coders Reach Finals

by *Irmak Yılmaz Dakak*

The stars of the future are shining. Our children have made us proud by reaching the finals in the coding olympiad through their discipline and great dedication. This achievement is the clearest proof of their strong potential. Thank you, children, for giving us this pride. Wishing you continued success and a bright future ahead.

One of our students, Seyit Çınar Sevin, earned an Honorable Mention (Merit Medal) in a highly challenging coding olympiad exam, a result that reflects his determination, discipline, and strong dedication. We are so proud of you, Seyit, and wish you continued success on your journey.





***Thank you for reading,
and supporting the ICS
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